the apparatus of knowing or due to conflict with another bit of knowledge. Prabhākara attributes error to some omission *(Akhyāti)* and Kumārila to commission *(Khyāti).*

According to *Mīmāmsā,* mere knowledge *(Jyāna)* does not lead to *Mokṣa* without detached performance of duty *(Karma).* The *Vedas,* it is maintained, determine *Dharma* (religious duties). *Sanyāsa,* or retirement from life, is not prescribed; performance of Vedic rites is deemed capable of achieving the cherished goal. In short, the *Mīmāmsā* discipline consists in doing the obligatory deeds and avoiding the prohibited ones which are the direct cause of birth and suffering.

The Vedānta (Absolutistic)

The *Uttar Mīmāmsā,* more popularly known as the *Vedānta,* is the *Upaniṣads* systematized and represents the cream of Indian thought. The *Upaniṣads,* the *Bhagavad-Gītā,* and the *Sūtras* of *Bādarayaṇa* form the base of the *Vedānta.* It may be classified as absolutistic, representing the Ultimate Reality as an impersonal principle, and theistic, representing the Ultimate Reality as a personal God. The absolutistic *Advaita* is represented by Śankara while the theistic type is represented by Rāmānuja and Mādhva.

Sankara (A.D. 788-820) maintained that the *Upaniṣads* really teach unity, their inclusion of diversity being only expository. The real, he held, is one, eternal, and of the essence of pure *Cit,* called the *Brahman.* The Absolute is changeless. The change attributed to the *Brahman* and the world is only apparent. Nothing else is. Yet the *Brahman* is not always realized as such. Thus, something other than the *Brahman* also is; the world also appears, but it is illusory as it is neither real nor unreal. It is of the nature of the "serpent in the rope," which is neither existent nor non-existent. The Absolute appears as the world just as the rope appears as a serpent. Thus the world has another kind of reality though not the Absolute Reality. The Absolute appears not only as the world but also as the individual Self. This is due to the delimiting adjuncts of the Self like the internal organ *(Antah-karaṇa).* The true Self is to be seen shorn of its conditionings. Just as one light appears to be different through different shades, even so the individual Self, when seen *sub specie aeternitatis,* is *Brahman* itself. Thus *Brahman* alone appears both as the objective universe and as the individual Self.

The Māyā

The appearance of the world and the plurality of the individual selves, if these are appearances, have to be adequately explained.